



Talanoa Staff Guide

tah-lah-NOH-ah · Tongan for *talking together*

A picture board that speaks. A resident taps a picture and the phone says the words out loud.



Scan to open Talanoa

<https://tcdeveloper27.github.io/Talanoa/>

Made for the residents of Faleofaz

What's inside

- | | |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1 What Talanoa is | 8 Updates |
| 2 Setting up a phone | 9 Without Wi-Fi |
| 3 The screen at a glance | 10 Tips for helping residents |
| 4 Talking with it | 11 If something goes wrong |
| 5 Moving between pages | 12 Looking after the phone |
| 6 The Mom & Dad page | 13 Asking for changes |
| 7 Settings | 14 Credits & contact |

1 What Talanoa is

Talanoa helps a person who can't speak tell you what they want, how they feel, and who they want to see. It was made for the residents of Faleofaz.

It works like a set of talking picture cards on a phone (or a tablet). Every picture says a short sentence out loud in a natural voice, for example the carrot picture says *"I want a snack."* The

words also appear in big letters at the top, so you can read them from across the room, and the picture that said them glows for 30 seconds.

There are 13 pages with 152 pictures in total, plus six important buttons that are always on screen.

Three promises the app keeps

- **It never stays silent.**
If a voice recording can't play, the phone's own voice says it instead.
- **The top row never moves.**
Its six buttons are always in the same place, so they can be found without looking.
- **It works without internet**
once it has been set up.

2 Setting up a phone

You only do this once per phone (a tablet works the same way). It takes about two minutes and needs Wi-Fi.

1

Open Google Chrome

Use Chrome, not a preview from email or Google Drive.

2

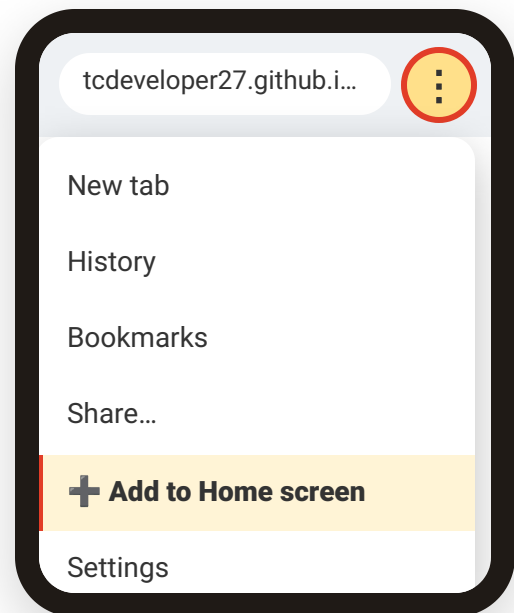
Go to the Talanoa address

Scan the QR code on the front of this guide with the phone's camera, or type
tcdeveloper27.github.io/Talanoa
(capital T in Talanoa).

3

Tap the  menu (three dots, top right)

Choose **Add to Home screen** or **Install app**, then confirm.



Step 3 (illustration). The menu on your phone may look a little different.

4

Open Talanoa from its new icon

It opens full screen like any other app.

5

Leave it on Wi-Fi for a minute

It saves the pictures and voice onto the phone. Check in Settings:

Status should say ✓ **Ready to use with no internet.**



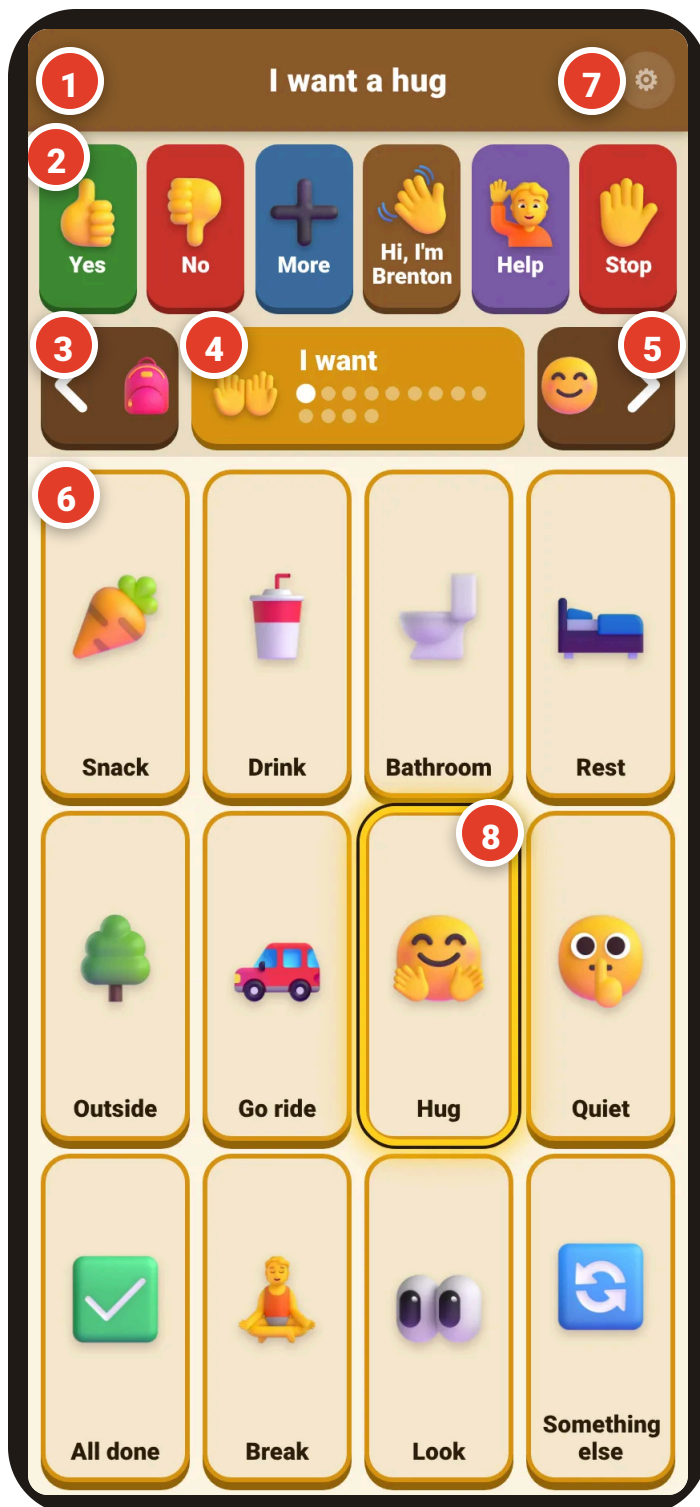
Step 4 (illustration). The Talanoa icon on the home screen.

Tip

Turn the media volume up with the side buttons, and set the screen to stay on longer (see section 12).

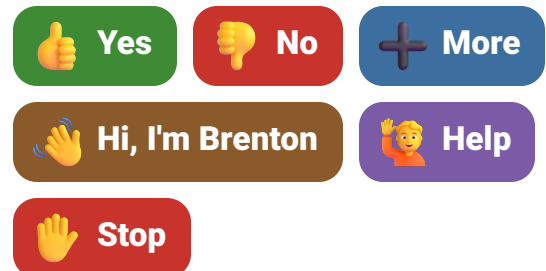
3 The screen at a glance

This is exactly what residents see. The numbers match the list below.



1 Spoken words. Shows what was just said, in big letters, so staff can read it too. It flashes green on every tap, and goes back to "Tap a picture to talk" after 30 seconds.

2 The six "always" buttons. On every page, never moving:



3 Back arrow ◀. Goes to the previous page. The small picture shows which page it goes to.

4 Page name. Shows which page you're on; the dots show where you are in the pages. **Tap it to see all pages at once.**

5 Next arrow ▶. Goes to the next page. After the last page it goes back to the first.

6

Picture tiles. 12 per page, always in the same spots. Tap one to speak. Swipe sideways across them to turn the page.

7

Settings ⚙️. For staff only. It opens only when you **press and hold it for one second**, so residents won't open it by accident.

8

The glow. The last picture tapped glows for 30 seconds, so the resident can lift the phone and show you what they said. Tapping another picture moves the glow to it.

It stays upright

Opened from its home-screen icon, Talanoa stays upright even when the phone is turned sideways, so the pictures stay big.

4 Talking with it

Tap a picture once and the phone says the words.



One tap = one sentence

No double-tapping needed. A tap still counts if the finger slides a little or rests on the picture for a while.



Tap again to repeat

It starts again from the beginning.



Quick taps are fine

A new tap stops the last sentence and says the new one. Nothing gets stuck.



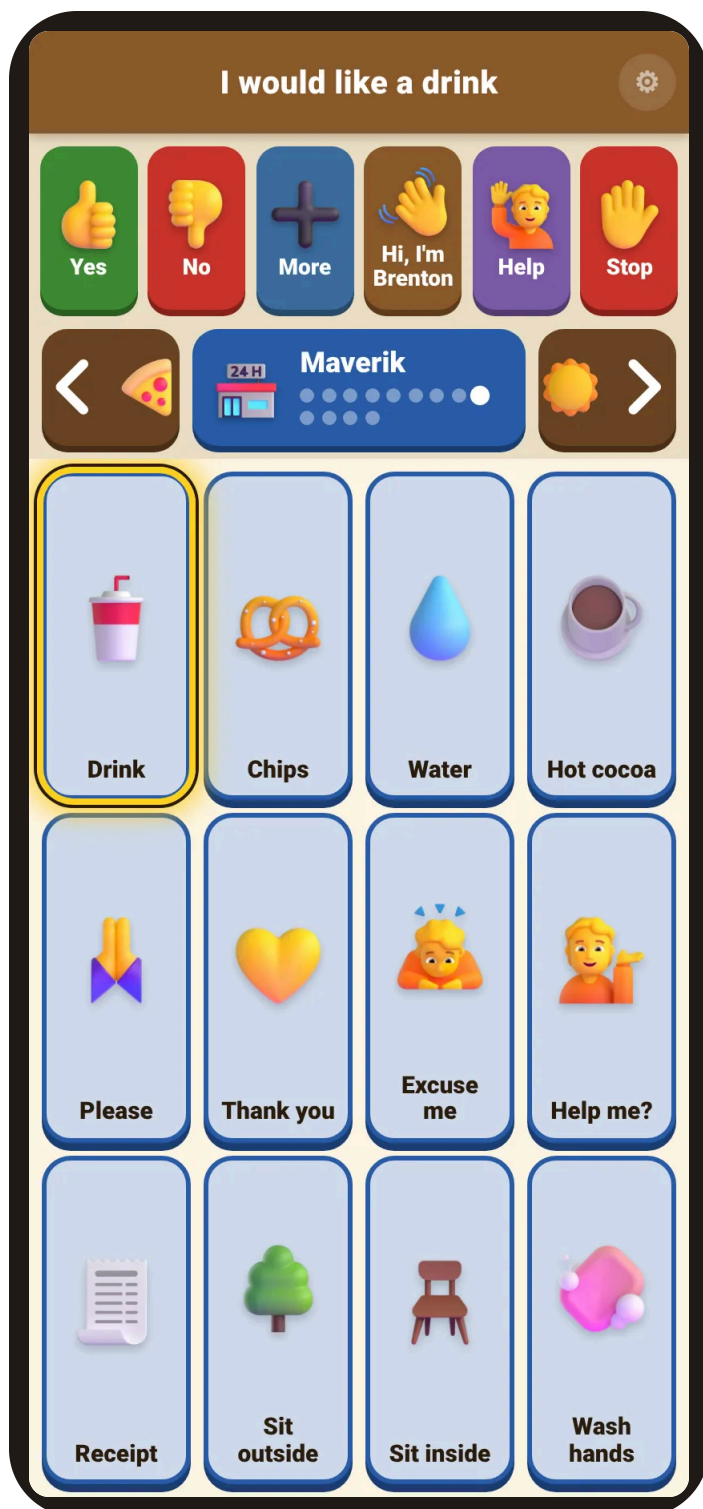
A little buzz

The phone vibrates slightly on each tap, if it can.



Show someone

The picture glows for 30 seconds, long enough to lift the phone and show a person what was said.



On the **Maverik** page, after tapping **Drink**. The top says "I would like a drink", and Drink glows.

5 Moving between pages

Use the big ◀▶ arrows to flip through the pages, like turning the pages of a book, or swipe sideways across the pictures.



Swipe to turn the page

Slide a finger sideways across the pictures, like on a phone's home screen. The page follows the finger; let go early and it springs back. A swipe never says anything.



Or tap the arrows

Each arrow shows a small picture of the page it goes to. After the last page it goes back to the first.

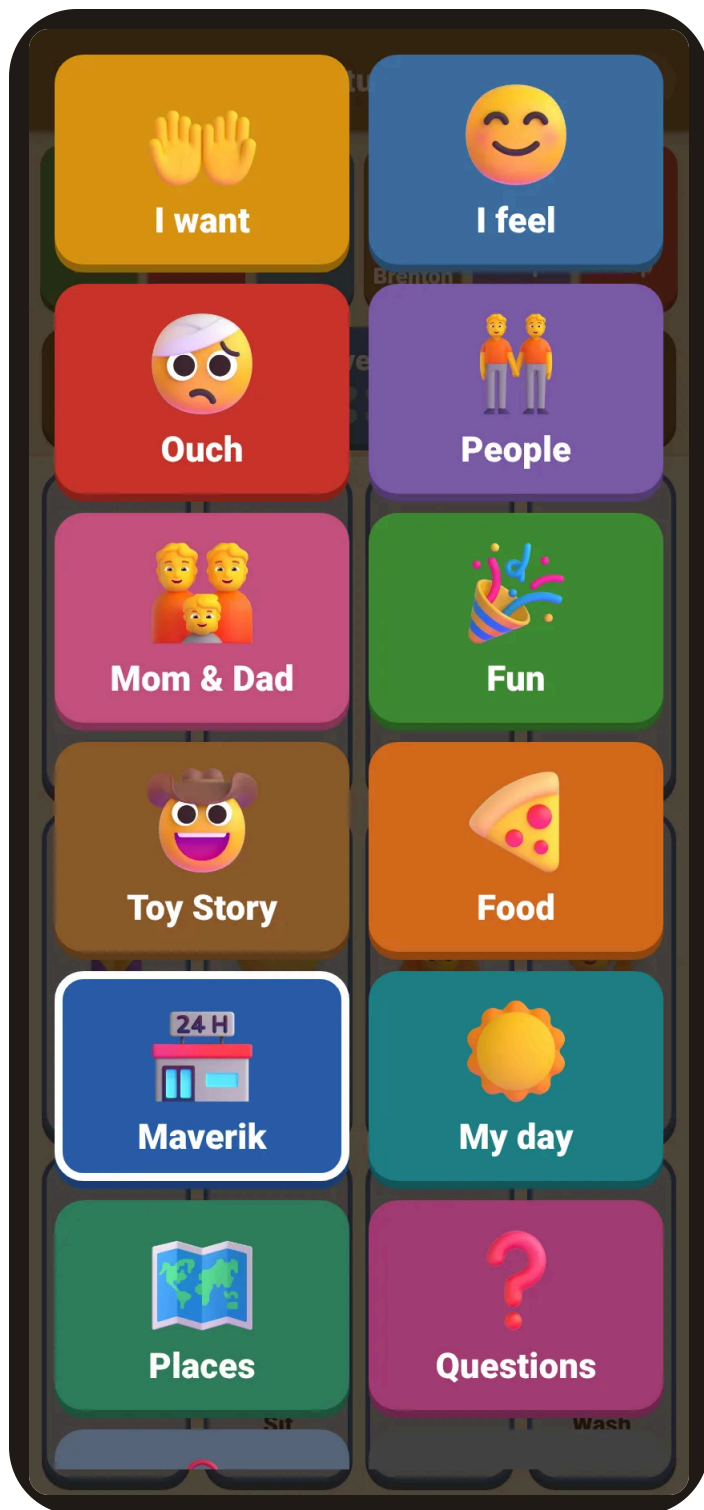


Jump straight to a page

Tap the page name in the middle. All pages appear as big buttons: tap one to go there, or tap **×** **Close**.

Pages turning by accident?

Swiping can be turned off in Settings. The arrows always work.



Tapping the page name shows every page.

The 13 pages, in order



I want

1

12 tiles: Snack, Drink, Bathroom, Rest...



I feel

2

12 tiles: Happy, Excited, Sad, Frustrated...



Ouch

3

12 tiles: Head, Tummy, Throw up, Tooth...



People

4

10 tiles: Family, Staff, Friend, Hi...



Mom & Dad

5

12 tiles: Dad, Call Dad, Dad's house, Dad coming?...



Fun

6

12 tiles: Toy Story, Cartoons, Movie, Costume...



Toy Story

7

12 tiles: Howdy, Bullseye, Infinity, Sky...



Food

8

11 tiles: Hungry, Water, Juice, Milk...



Maverik

9

12 tiles: Drink, Chips, Water, Hot cocoa...



My day

10

12 tiles: Wake up, Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner...



Places

11

12 tiles: Home, My room, Store, Park...



Questions

12

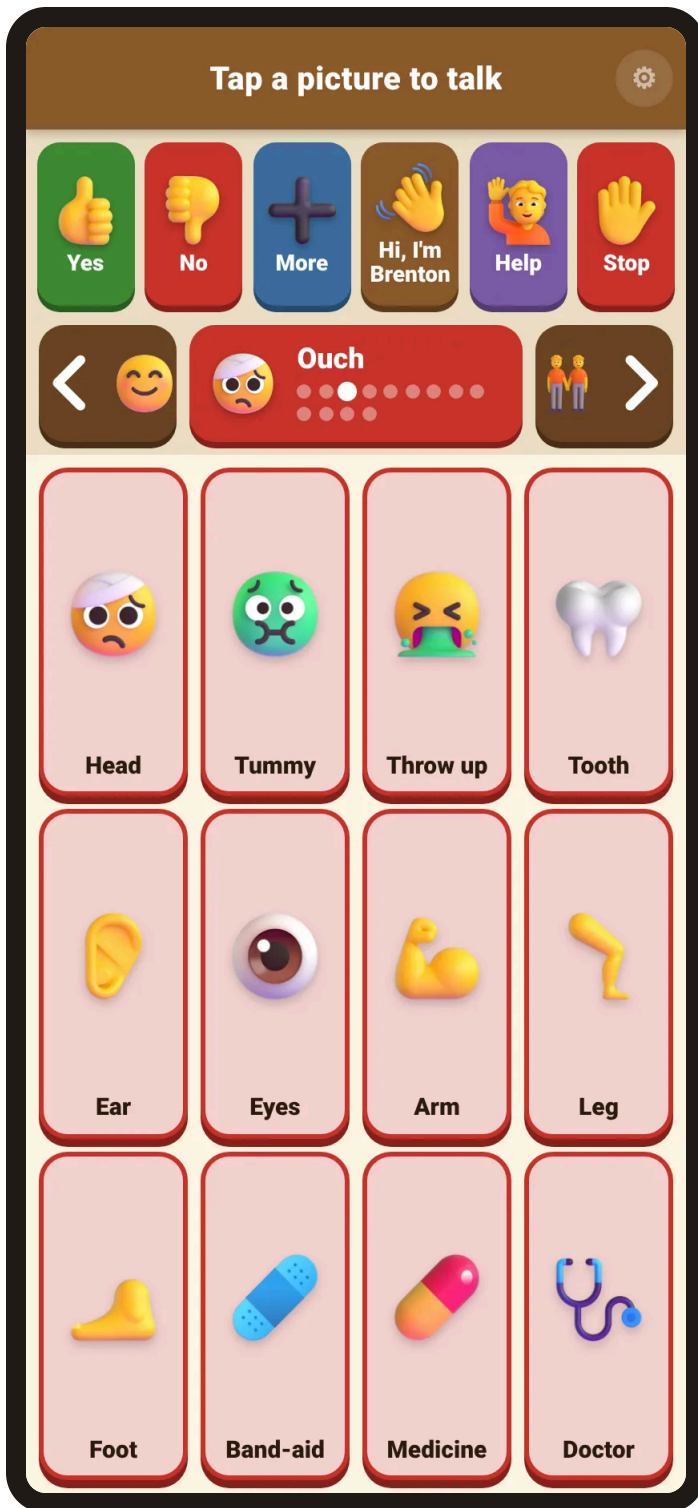
11 tiles: What now?, What's next?, Where to?, Who?...



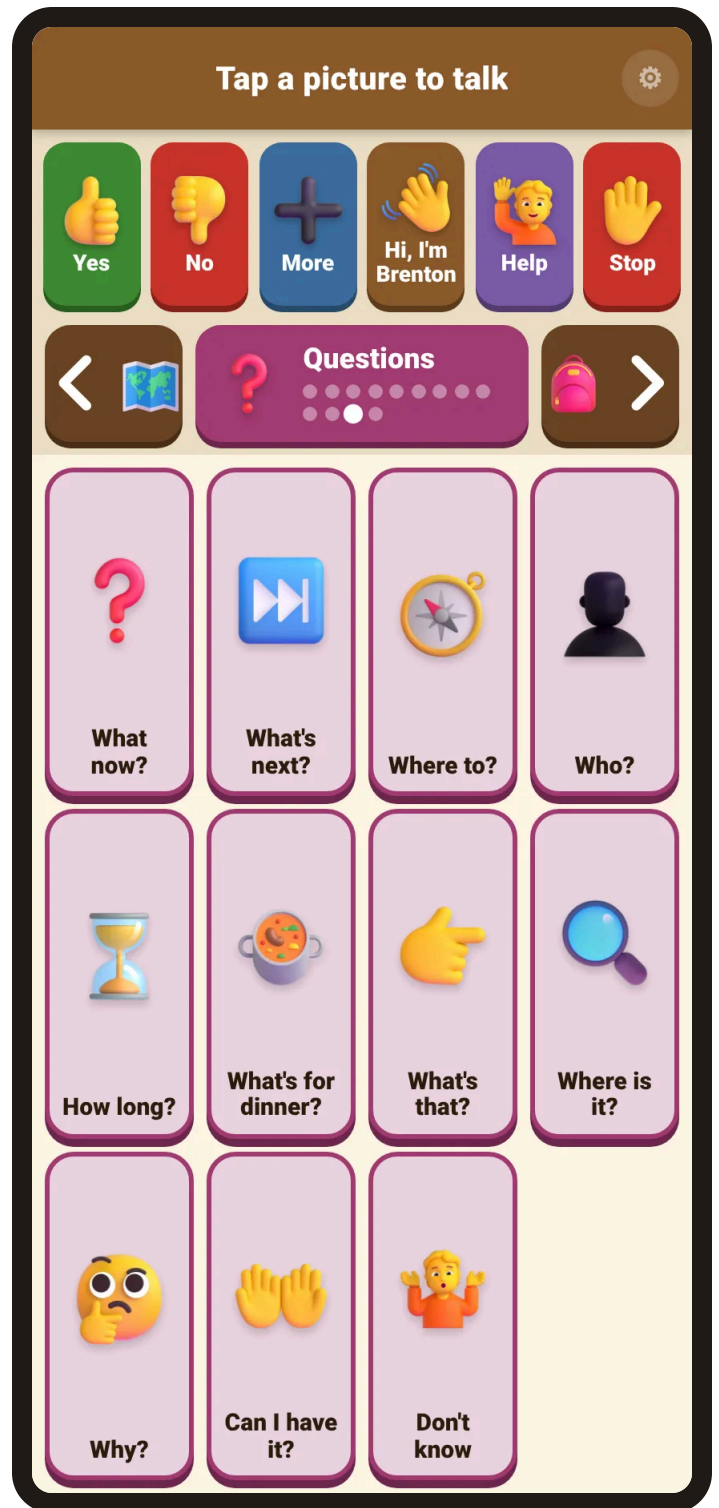
Things

13

12 tiles: Headphones, Hat, Jacket, Sunglasses...



Ouch: point to where it hurts.



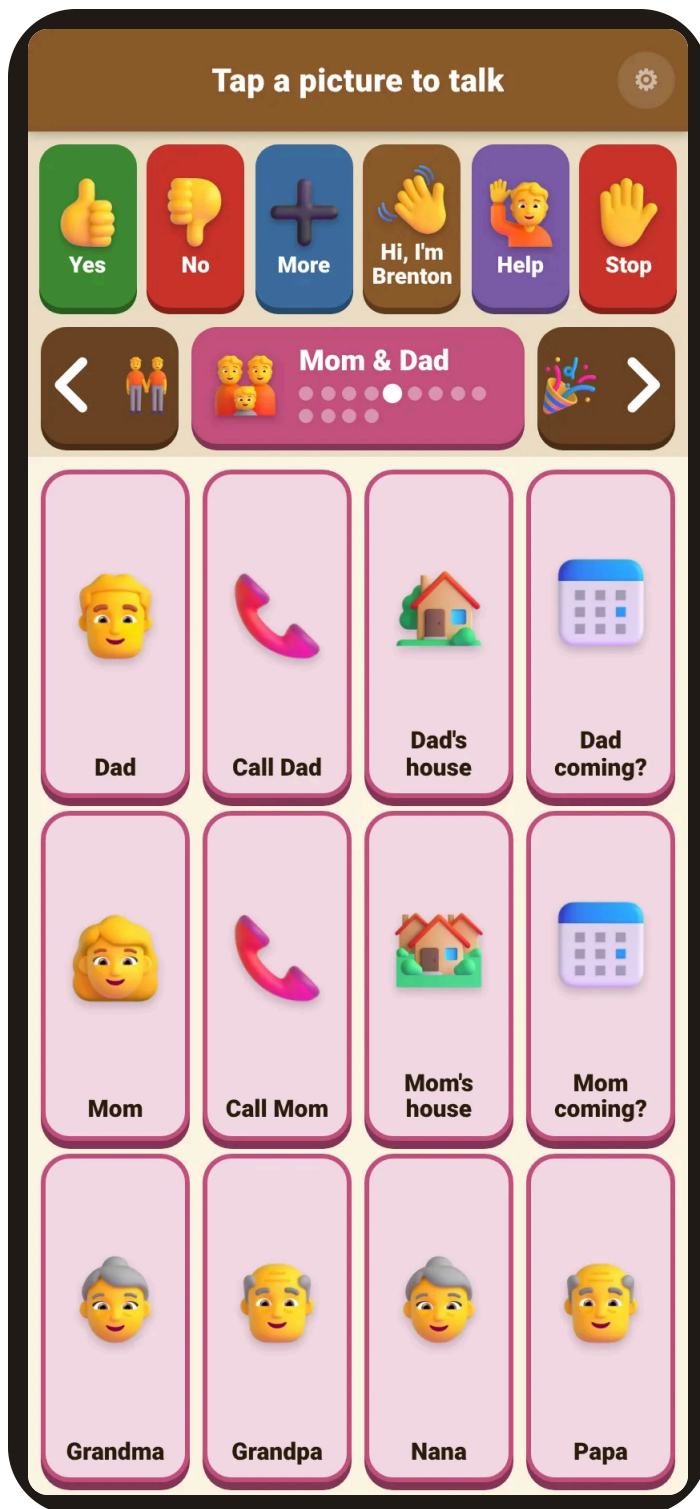
Questions: what's next, where, who, how long.

Pages can be hidden

If a resident doesn't need a page, it can be turned off on that phone in Settings.

6 The Mom & Dad page

All the parent and grandparent tiles are together on one page.



Every Dad tile has the matching Mom tile **directly underneath it**: Dad and Mom, Call Dad and Call Mom, Dad's house and Mom's house, Dad coming? and Mom coming? The bottom row has Grandma, Grandpa, Nana and Papa.

This layout is deliberate

The family asked that Mom always appears under Dad. The app is built so this can't be changed by accident.

When a resident taps "Call Dad" or "Call Mom"

Treat it as a real request: tell them what will happen ("Let's call Mom after lunch") so they know they were heard.

7 Settings

Settings belong to each phone. Changing them on one phone doesn't change any other.



Press and hold the ⚙️ in the top-right corner

Keep your finger on it for 1 second, then let go

Settings

For caregivers: hold the ⚙️ for 1 second to open.

Voice

☒ **Michael** calm man A

☐ **Fenrir** deeper man

☐ **Heart** warm woman

☐ **Bella** bright young woman

☐ **Sarah** friendly woman

☐ **George** British man

☐ **Emma** British woman

☐ **Built-in voice** the voice built into this phone or tablet

Built-in voice (also used as a backup)

Automatic: best available ▼

Speed: 1.00

B

Volume: 1.0

A

Voice. Tap a name to choose it. You'll hear "Hi! This is my voice." Choose the one that suits the resident.

B

Speed. Slide left for slower speech, right for faster. 1.00 is normal.

C

Volume. The app's own loudness. Also check the phone's side buttons.

The 7 voices

Voice	Sounds like
Michael default	calm man
Fenrir	deeper man
Heart	warm woman
Bella	bright young woman
Sarah	friendly woman
George	British man
Emma	British woman
Built-in voice	the voice built into the phone or tablet (sound depends on the device)

The screenshot shows the 'Pages to show' section with 12 toggle switches, all of which are checked. The 'Turning pages' section has a toggle for 'Swipe to change pages' which is also checked. The 'Status' section shows a green bar indicating 'Ready to use with no internet (pictures and voice saved on this device)'. Below this is the version number '5507e3a76255' and the last checked date 'Sep 26, 1:30 AM'. A 'Check for updates now' button is visible. At the bottom, there are links for 'Staff guide' and 'About & credits', and a 'Done' button.

D Pages to show. Untick a page to hide it on this phone; tick it to bring it back. At least one page always stays on.

E Swipe to change pages. On to start with. Untick it if pages turn by accident; the ◀▶ arrows always work.

F Status. "✓ Ready to use with no internet" means everything is saved. Below it you'll see the version and when it last checked for updates.

G Check for updates now. Gets the newest version straight away (see section 8).

H Done button.

D **Pages to show.** Untick a page to hide it on this phone; tick it to bring it back. At least one page always stays on.

E **Swipe to change pages.** On to start with. Untick it if pages turn by accident; the ◀▶ arrows always work.

F **Status.** "✓ Ready to use with no internet" means everything is saved. Below it you'll see the version and when it last checked for updates.

G **Check for updates now.** Gets the newest version straight away (see section 8).



About & credits. Who made Talanoa and how to contact Faleofaz.

Tap **Done** at the bottom to close Settings.

8 Updates

You don't have to do anything. New words and fixes arrive by themselves.



The family changes
the words



The new version is
published online



The phone
downloads it quietly
in the background



It switches on when
nobody is using the
board

- The phone checks when Talanoa opens, when the screen turns back on, and every 30 minutes.
- It **never changes while someone is tapping**. It waits until nobody has tapped for 2 minutes, or the screen is off, and then comes back on the same page.
- **To update right now:** hold ⚙ → **Check for updates now**. If there's something new, the app restarts by itself with it.

The message says...	Meaning
✓ You have the latest version.	Nothing to do.
Downloading the new version... the app will restart by itself.	Wait a few seconds.
A new version is ready and will switch on when the board is not in use.	It will update on its own soon.
Could not check: no internet connection right now.	Connect to Wi-Fi and try again. The board still works normally.

Without Wi-Fi

Once the phone shows ✓ **Ready to use with no internet**, Talanoa works anywhere: on outings, in the car, at the store, or when the Wi-Fi is down. Pictures, words and the chosen voice are all saved on the phone.

After choosing a new voice

Keep the phone on Wi-Fi for a minute so the new voice can be saved. Until then, any sentence that isn't saved yet uses the phone's own voice. It's never silent.

10 Tips for helping residents

A talking board works best when the people around it use it too.



Show, don't test

While you talk, tap the pictures yourself ("Let's have *lunch*", tapping Lunch). This is how people learn where things are. Never quiz them.



Give time

Wait after asking a question. Finding the right picture can take a while.



Every tap counts

Answer what was said, even if you think it was an accident. That's how they learn their words have power.



Keep it close and charged

The board only helps if it's within reach, all day, in every room.



Tell the family

Let the family know which pictures get used, and which words are missing.

Talanoa supports, it doesn't replace

Talanoa is a simple, friendly board, not a full professional speech system. A speech-language pathologist can suggest what each resident needs.

11 If something goes wrong

What you notice

What to do

No sound at all

Turn the volume up with the phone's side buttons. Check the phone isn't on silent. In Settings, check **Volume** isn't low.

The voice sounds robotic	In Settings, Built-in voice is probably chosen. Choose Michael (or another named voice).
Only a brown bar, no pictures	It was opened in a preview (from email or Google Drive). Open Talanoa from its home-screen icon, or in Chrome.
A page is missing	Settings → Pages to show → tick it.
Settings won't open	Press and hold the ⚙ for a full second. A quick tap does nothing, on purpose.
New words from the family aren't showing	Connect to Wi-Fi, then Settings → Check for updates now .
"404 / There isn't a GitHub Pages site here"	The address was typed wrong. Use the QR code, or type tcdeveloper27.github.io/Talanoa with a capital T.
The ► arrow (or a swipe) jumped back to "I want"	That's normal: after the last page it starts again at the first.
Pages keep turning by accident	Settings → untick Swipe to change pages . The ◀▶ arrows still work.
A picture is glowing	That's the last picture tapped. It stops glowing by itself after 30 seconds, or as soon as another picture is tapped.
The screen keeps turning off	See "Screen timeout" in section 12.
Something else looks wrong	Close Talanoa completely and open it again from its icon. If it still happens, take a photo of the screen and email it to Tim Broussard at tcdeveloper@gmail.com .

12 Looking after the phone



Charge every night

A flat battery means a resident with no voice.



Volume

Use the side buttons while Talanoa is talking to set how loud it is.



Screen timeout

On most Android phones: **Settings** → **Display** → **Screen timeout**, and choose a longer time (for example 10 minutes).



Clean and protect

Wipe the screen with a slightly damp cloth. A sturdy case is a good idea.

13 Asking for changes

New words, different wording, a real photo of someone instead of a picture: the family can add these. Write down what's needed (for example "*add Swing, 'I want to go on the swing'*") and pass it to **Tim Broussard**. The change reaches the phone automatically, usually the same day.

Tim Broussard

✉ tcdeveloper@gmail.com

14 Credits & contact

Talanoa was made with love for the residents of Faleofaz, by:

Tim Broussard

tcdeveloper@gmail.com

Brenton Broussard

Legion

Faleofaz

Faleofaz

📞 801-317-5454

✉️ faleofaz@utfaleofaz.org

📍 West Valley City, Utah, serving Salt Lake County residents

📷 @faleofaz_llc · 🌐 faleofaz.org

Pictures: Fluent Emoji © Microsoft (MIT licence). Voices recorded with Kokoro, an open-source speech model (Apache 2.0).

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